Board 1
North Deals
None Vul

	♠ 7 6 4 ♥ A K 9 7 4 3 ♦ 7 2 ♣ Q 5	
♠ A 8 ♥ 10 6 5 ♦ J 10 8 ♣ 10 9 8 7 3		♠ J 10 9 5 3 2 ♥ 8 2 ♦ 9 4 3 ♣ A 6
	♠ K Q ♥ Q J ♦ A K Q 6 5 ♣ K J 4 2	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	2♥	Pass	4♥
All Pass			

4♥ by North
Lead: ♠J

NORTH is too weak to open 1♥ but just right for 2♥.

Wow! SOUTH has 21 HCP and two good ♥s. Could this be time for a slam try?

Nope, no slam here. Suppose NORTH has six ♥s headed by the AK. The trump suit would certainly be solid, but then NORTH couldn't possibly have an outside Ace as well or he would have been too strong for a Weak-two opening. So SOUTH just bids 4♥.

Board 2
South Deals
None Vul

♠ A Q 5
♥ 4
♦ K Q 9 4
♣ K J 7 4 2

♠ 10 9 7
♥ A 10 9 8 3
♦ A 10 3
♣ 10 3

♠ K 6 4 2
♥ 5
♦ J 7 6 2
♣ A Q 9 6

♠ J 8 3
♥ K Q J 7 6 2
♦ 8 5
♣ 8 5

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			2♥
All Pass			

2♥ by South
Lead: ♣10

NORTH really hates that 2♥ opening by SOUTH.

But there's no sense bidding and probably making matters worse, so she grits her teeth and passes.

If you think 3NT has a chance you are delusional.

Board 3
South Deals
E-W Vul

	♠ A Q J 10 6 5 ♥ 7 ♦ A 9 5 ♣ K J 3	
♠ 7 3 2 ♥ K 8 5 ♦ K 10 8 6 2 ♣ 7 2	N W E S	♠ 9 ♥ J 9 3 ♦ Q J 7 3 ♣ A Q 10 8 4
	♠ K 8 4 ♥ A Q 10 6 4 2 ♦ 4 ♣ 9 6 5	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			2♥
Pass	2♠	Pass	3♠
Pass	4♠		
All Pass			

4♠ by North
Lead: ♠9

NORTH expects to be better off in ♠s than SOUTH would be in 2♥.

Whether or not you play a new suit as a one round force or not, SOUTH should make the 3♠ bid with a hand this good. NORTH then bids the ♠ game.

Board 4
South Deals
None Vul

♠ A K 7 5
♥ K 6 3
♦ K Q J 5 4
♣ A

♠ Q J 10 8 3
♥ 10 9
♦ A 8
♣ K J 10 7

♠ 9 4 2
♥ 2
♦ 10 9 7
♣ Q 9 6 5 3 2

♠ 6
♥ A Q J 8 7 5 4
♦ 6 3 2
♣ 8 4

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			3♥
Pass	4NT[1]	Pass	5♦[2]
Pass	6♥		
All Pass			

1. Blackwood
2. 1 ace

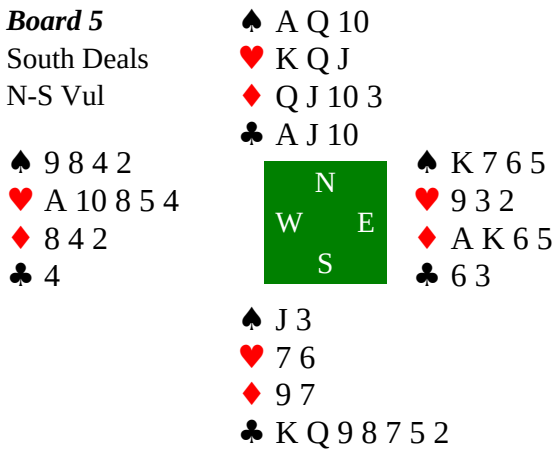
6♥ by South
Lead: ♠Q

SOUTH has a pretty normal 3♥ opening bid.

NORTH, however, has a big hand, and she launches into Blackwood.

When SOUTH shows one Ace NORTH can bid 6♥ with confidence.

Board 5
South Deals
N-S Vul



West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			3♣
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			

3NT by North
Lead: ♦K

SOUTH doesn't have much of a 3♣ opening bid.

But NORTH has just the type of hand you need to bid 3NT after partner's preempt. The other three suits well stopped, and certain entry in Opener's long suit. Notice here that 3NT is a good contract, but 5♣ would go down 1.

Board 6
South Deals
None Vul

	♠ A Q 6 3 ♥ Q 8 2 ♦ A K Q ♣ K Q J	
♠ 10 7 5 ♥ 7 5 ♦ J 6 4 3 ♣ A 8 6 3		♠ K 9 8 2 ♥ A 4 ♦ 10 9 2 ♣ 10 9 7 5
	♠ J 4 ♥ K J 10 9 6 3 ♦ 8 7 5 ♣ 4 2	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			2♥
Pass	2NT	Pass	3♥
Pass	4♥		
All Pass			

4♥ by South
Lead: ♦4

When SOUTH opens with a Weak 2♥ bid, NORTH knows she will force to game but is thinking about slam.

But first she needs to know if SOUTH has anything extra. She bids 2NT to get more information.

SOUTH returns to ♥s to show bare minimum so NORTH settles for game.